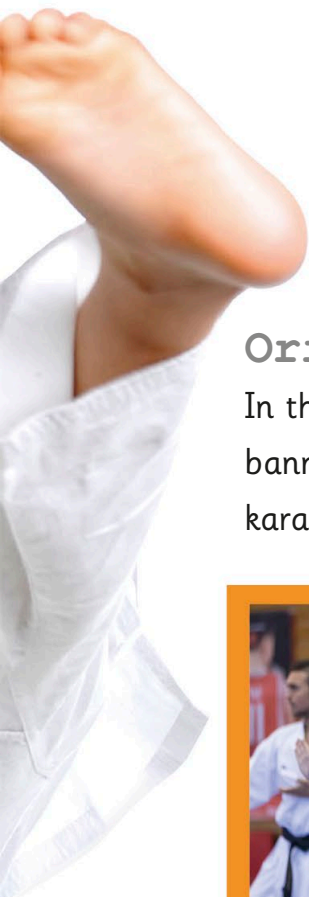




Origins

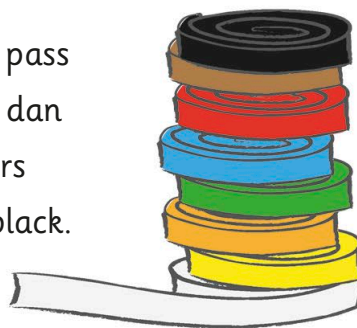
In the 17th century, fighting with weapons was banned on Okinawa, so its warriors came up with karate. The word karate means “**empty hand**.”



Karate's popularity spread to the United States when Okinawa became an important US military base after World War II.

Gaining belts

As karateka improve at karate, they pass through several ranks (**dans**). Each dan has a different colored belt. Beginners start with white, and experts wear black.



Types of move

Karate is known for striking actions such as palm heel, knife hand, and spear hand strikes. But karate is mostly about self-defense and developing **balance** between the mind and body.



Palm heel strike



Knife hand strike



Spear hand strike

Number of players:



Equipment:



Karate suit (karategi) and belt (obi)